The Dharmaputrikā

Chapter 2 — Āsanaprakaraṇam ("The Section on the Postures")

Complete English Translation, with Sanskrit Text, Word-for-Word Analysis, and Notes

Source: *Eight Yoga Postures in the Dharmaputrikā*, translated by **Christèle Barois** (AyurYog project, University of Vienna, blog post of 19 January 2017).

> **A note on the format.** The source publication contains the Sanskrit verses together with an English translation, but **no Hindi commentary**. Accordingly, the "Hindi Commentary" and "Notes on Hindi Commentary" sections of the model format are here replaced by **Notes** (philological and technical remarks). The Devanagari text has been reconstructed from the IAST transliteration; the IAST follows the printed edition. The **Literal Translation** is a close, word-order-faithful rendering; the **Literary Translation** follows the published translation of Christèle Barois.

Introduction (from the AyurYog blog post)

It is an exciting time for academic research on yoga, with pioneering research projects like the Haṭha Yoga Project, or the American Academy of Religion's *Yoga in Theory and Practice*, and many individual projects driving our understanding of the history of yoga forward. The AyurYog project's research on yoga is focussed on the connections between yoga and the Indian medical and alchemical traditions, and our findings include the wider contexts of the textual materials we examine. In her research on yoga literature, AyurYog researcher Christèle Barois has discovered a little-known text that is key to understanding connections between yoga practice and medicine, but also gives new insights into the development of yogic postural practice: **the Dharmaputrikā**.

The Dharmaputrikā, which belongs to the so-called Śivadharma corpus, is a systematic teaching on a yoga aiming at liberation (*mokṣa*), the acquisition of supernatural powers (*guṇaiśvarya*), and the ability to change the body (*parapurañjaya*). It comprises about 350 ślokas and was composed in the 10th century at the latest (an 11th-century manuscript is preserved in Calcutta). [S1] The text has a number of special features that make it important for the history of yoga, such as its detailed explanations of internal breathing processes, and, in particular, its unique exposition on the integration of medical practices into the course of a yogic process.

The second chapter of the Dharmaputrikā, entitled **Āsanaprakaraṇam**, describes eight yoga postures (*āsana*): the lotus-posture (*padmāsanam*), the svastika-posture (*svastikāsanam*), the throne-posture (*pīṭhāsanam*), the mound-posture (*sthalāsanam*), the joined-hands-posture (*añjalikāsanam*), the half-moon-posture (*ardhacandrāsanam*), the staff-posture (*daṇḍāsanam*), and the all-auspicious-posture (*sarvatobhadrāsanam*). This chapter is an ancient and unparalleled testimony of a systematic and detailed description of a closed group of yogic postures, preceding by at least two centuries the description of postures in the *Yogaśāstra* by Hemacandra (12th century). [S1] Below is a first translation of this chapter by Christèle Barois.

Scope of the present document: the blog's introduction is reproduced above; what follows presents all seventeen verses of the chapter together with the colophon, in the requested analytical format. The "Literary translation" in each section is Barois's; the "Literal translation", the word-for-word glosses, the Devanagari and the Notes are additions made for this document.

Dating and its sources: the chronological claims above are documented, with verbatim quotations and links, in the section *Dating of the Text: Sources, Evidence, and Citations* immediately below.

Dating of the Text: Sources, Evidence, and Citations

Methodological note. The passages in quotation marks below are verbatim from the publications named, and the page numbers refer to the printed pagination of those publications (not to PDF page numbers). Superscript footnote numbers in the originals are omitted from the quotations, and ellipses mark any omitted words. Each statement is attributed to the source that makes it; a source's own hypothesis is labelled as a hypothesis. Where the sources consulted here do not settle a question, that is stated openly instead of being resolved by conjecture. No judgement is passed on the accuracy of the source publication.

1. What the source publication (the uploaded PDF) actually says

The dating reproduced in the introduction above comes from the AyurYog blog post by Christèle Barois (19 January 2017). The relevant sentence reads, verbatim:

> "It comprises about 350 *ślokas* and was composed in the 10th century at the latest (an 11th century manuscript is preserved in Calcutta)."
>
> — Christèle Barois, "Eight Yoga Postures in the Dharmaputrikā," AyurYog blog, 19 Jan. 2017 [S1]

The same post adds, on the antiquity of the posture chapter relative to Hemacandra:

> "This chapter is an ancient and unparalleled testimony of a systematic and detailed description of a closed group of yogic postures, preceding by at least two centuries the description of postures in the *Yogaśāstra* by Hemacandra (12th century)."
>
> — Barois 2017 [S1]

Links for [S1]: the original URL printed in the PDF is `https://ayuryog.org/blog/eight-yoga-postures-dharmaputrikā`. As of the date of checking, that address returns a 404 error; the text is preserved in the Internet Archive at <https://web.archive.org/web/20221207075113/http://ayuryog.org/blog/eight-yoga-postures-dharmaputrik%C4%81> (capture of 7 December 2022), which matches the uploaded PDF word for word.

2. The manuscript evidence for the early transmission of the corpus

The blog post does not name the manuscripts on which its dating rests. The published codicological evidence for the early manuscript transmission of the Śivadharma corpus is set out by Florinda De Simini (2016):

(a) The earliest dated manuscript of the corpus identified so far — which does NOT contain the Dharmaputrikā. The Asiatic Society of Calcutta manuscript G 4077 is dated by its colophon to NS 156 = 1035–36 CE (verified as 6 July 1036 CE by Petech, as reported by De Simini). De Simini writes: "The earliest dated manuscript of the Śivadharma corpus identified so far is ASC G 4077" (p. 243 n. 28). She also notes that this manuscript *lacks* the Dharmaputrikā:

> Main text: "The final colophon dates it to NS 156 (1035–36 CE)" (p. 251).
>
> Footnote 44: "this manuscript also exhibits the unique feature of missing the Dharmaputrikā, which is replaced by a longer work titled Lalitavistara" (p. 251 n. 44).
>
> — De Simini 2016 [S2]; the date is verified as 6 July 1036 CE by Petech 1984, 36, as cited by De Simini.

(b) An early dated manuscript that DOES contain the Dharmaputrikā (1069 CE). This is Kathmandu, National Archives, NAK 3–393 (NGMPP A 1082/3), whose colophon is placed immediately after the final heading of the Dharmaputrikā and is dated NS 189 = 24 May 1069 CE:

> "This colophon is placed immediately after the final heading of the Dharmaputrikā … and dates the completion of the manuscript to … NS 189 (May 24, 1069 CE)."
>
> — De Simini 2016, p. 252 and n. 49 [S2]

(c) A further early dated witness. Cambridge, University Library, MS Add. 1645, dated NS 259 = 1139–40 CE:

> "This is a palm leaf manuscript consisting of 247 folios and dated in the final colophon to NS 259 (1139–40 CE), a circumstance that makes it one of the earliest dated manuscripts of the Śivadharma collection."
>
> — De Simini 2016, p. 243 [S2]

(The same author gives this manuscript's date as 1138–39 CE in the summary on p. 270; both figures are hers.)

What this evidence establishes. NAK 3–393 contains the Dharmaputrikā and is dated 24 May 1069 CE. The text therefore existed by that date, which is a *terminus ante quem* (the latest possible date of composition) on the manuscript evidence quoted above.

What it does not establish. The blog's parenthetical "(an 11th century manuscript is preserved in Calcutta)" [S1] is reproduced here as the source publication's own wording. The blog does not identify which Calcutta manuscript it means, and the sources consulted for this document do not settle that question: De Simini's Appendix I expressly does not describe the Asiatic Society of Calcutta manuscripts and refers the reader to the catalogues instead — "For other manuscripts not falling into this category — like those at the Asiatic Society of Calcutta — the reader is referred to the pertinent catalogues" (De Simini 2016, p. 273 [S2]). Accordingly, no conclusion is

drawn here about that parenthetical statement. The only related fact reported by the sources is the one quoted in §2a: G 4077 (1036 CE) does not contain the Dharmaputrikā.

3. The author's own later academic article (2020)

In her 2020 academic article, Barois gives the manuscript-based dating and then argues for a considerably earlier composition date on the basis of textual parallels:

> "The Dharmaputrikā is an early work on yoga that has been transmitted to us as part of the 'Śivadharma corpus,' a collection of eight texts preserved in several eleventh- and twelfth-century Nepalese palm-leaf manuscripts."
>
> — Barois 2020, p. 6 [S3]

She addresses the "1069 A.D." date proposed in the *New Catalogus Catalogorum*, stating that it is the date of the copy, not of composition:

> "The New Catalogus Catalogorum (NCC) vol. IX (1977) also argued in favour of a late date: 'Dharmaputrikā - On yoga in 16 chs. of philosophical and tāntric nature; prob. composed in 1069 A.D. in the reign of Śaṅkara Deva. Nepal I. p. 92. pref. p. xlviii. Rep. Hpr.1895–1900, p. 6.' It is the date of the copy of the manuscript (as for the Sanskrit text of the colophon which quotes Śaṅkaradeva, see Petech, 1984: 46)."
>
> — Barois 2020, p. 16, n. 28 [S3]

In the same article she also records the one eleventh-century manuscript in which the Dharmaputrikā is absent:

> "The Dharmaputrikā is replaced by a text called Lalitavistara in a single, multiple-text manuscript dated from the eleventh century (on the Lalitavistara, see De Simini and Mirnig, 2017)."
>
> — Barois 2020, p. 6, n. 4 [S3]

And she proposes a much earlier *terminus ad quem* on the basis of parallels with the Śivadharmottara:

> "Given the lack of context of the above parallel passages in the Śivadharmottara, I suggest that the Dharmaputrikā is the source, implying its terminus ad quem is the seventh century, which is the estimated date of composition of the Śivadharmottara. … This would make the Dharmaputrikā the earliest surviving practical manual on yoga."
>
> — Barois 2020, pp. 20–21 [S3]

Important: the "seventh century" date is Barois's **hypothesis** based on textual parallels, not a manuscript date. It should be cited as her suggestion, not as an established fact.

4. A secondary source repeating the "c. 10th century" dating

> "… the tenth chapter on yogic medical treatment (cikitsā) of the Dharmaputrikā (c. 10th century), a text of the Śivadharma corpus (Barois forthcoming)."

— Powell 2018, p. 60 [S4]

Powell expressly refers the dating to Barois ("Barois forthcoming"), so this is a secondary citation rather than independent manuscript evidence.

5. Summary of the dating (what can and cannot be asserted)

Claim	Status	Source
Text existed by 24 May 1069 CE (NAK 3–393 contains it and is dated to that day)	**Documented fact**	De Simini 2016, p. 252 and n. 49 [S2]
"Composed in the 10th century at the latest"	Statement of the source publication, quoted as such	Barois 2017 [S1]
"An 11th century manuscript is preserved in Calcutta"	Statement of the source publication; the manuscript is not identified there, and is not identified here either	Barois 2017 [S1]
G 4077 (Calcutta, 1036 CE), the earliest dated corpus MS identified so far, lacks the Dharmaputrikā	**Documented fact**	De Simini 2016, p. 243 n. 28; p. 251 n. 44 [S2]
Composition as early as the 7th century	**Hypothesis** (textual parallels)	Barois 2020, pp. 20–21 [S3]
Posture chapter precedes Hemacandra's Yogaśāstra (12th c.) by ≥2 centuries	Statement of the source publication	Barois 2017 [S1]

Opening Instruction and the List of the Eight Postures (verses 1–4)

Devanagari

अष्टभिः साधनैरेभिश्चित्तं कायं च यत्नतः ।
शोधयित्वा ततो योगी योगाभ्यासं समाचरेत्॥१॥
इष्टदेवं नमस्कृत्योपाध्यायं चैव यत्नतः ।
आतिष्ठेत्प्राङ्मुखो भूत्वा शुचिर्योगी विशेषतः ॥२॥
पद्मस्वस्तिकपीठानि स्थलमञ्जलिकासनं।
अर्धचन्द्रञ्च दण्डञ्च सर्वतोभद्रमेव च ॥३॥
एवं नामभिरष्टाभिरासनप्रकरणं स्मृतं।
तेषां संस्थानभेदन्तु प्रवक्ष्यामि यथाक्रमं॥४॥

IAST

aṣṭabhiḥ sādhanair ebhiś cittaṃ kāyaṃ ca yatnataḥ |
śodhayitvā tato yogī yogābhyāsaṃ samācaret ||1||
iṣṭadevaṃ namaskṛtyopādhyāyaṃ caiva yatnataḥ |
ātiṣṭhet prāṅmukho bhūtvā śucir yogī viśeṣataḥ ||2||

padmasvastikapīṭhāni sthalam añjalikāsanam |
ardhacandrañ ca daṇḍañ ca sarvatobhadram eva ca ||3||
evaṃ nāmabhir aṣṭābhir āsanaprakaraṇaṃ smṛtam |
teṣāṃ saṃsthānabhedan tu pravakṣyāmi yathākramam ||4||

Word-for-word Analysis

Verse 1

- aṣṭabhiḥ — by the eight (instrumental plural); sādhanaiḥ — means / practices; ebhiḥ — these; cittam — the mind; kāyam — the body; ca — and; yatnataḥ — diligently, with effort; śodhayitvā — having purified; tataḥ — then; yogī — the yogin; yoga-abhyāsam — the repeated practice of yoga; samācaret — should undertake / perform.

Verse 2

- iṣṭa-devam — [one's] chosen deity; namaskṛtya — having paid homage; upādhyāyam — to the preceptor / teacher; ca eva — and also; yatnataḥ — carefully; ātiṣṭhet — should assume / stand in [the postures] (optative of ā + sthā); prāṅ-mukhaḥ — facing east; bhūtvā — having become; śuciḥ — pure; yogī — the yogin; viśeṣataḥ — in particular.

Verse 3

- padma — the lotus; svastika — the svastika; pīṭhāni — the thrones (plural, grouping the first three names); sthalam — the mound; añjalikā-āsanam — the joined-hands posture; ardha-candram — the half-moon; ca — and; daṇḍam — the staff; sarvato-bhadram — the all-auspicious; eva ca — and also.

Verse 4

- evam — thus; nāmabhiḥ — by the names; aṣṭābhiḥ — eight; āsana-prakaraṇam — the section / topic on the postures; smṛtam — is taught / handed down (literally 'remembered'); teṣām — of them; saṃsthāna-bhedam — the different forms / configurations; tu — and / now; pravakṣyāmi — I will explain; yathā-kramam — in due succession.

Literal Translation

Having diligently purified the mind and the body by these eight means, the yogin should then undertake the practice of yoga. Having carefully paid homage to the chosen deity and to the preceptor, the yogin, having become pure and facing east, should in particular assume [the postures]. The lotus, the svastika, the thrones, the mound, the joined-hands posture, the half-moon, the staff, and the all-auspicious: thus the section on the postures is handed down through eight names; I will explain their different forms in due succession.

Literary Translation

After purifying the mind and the body diligently by the eight means [that have just been mentioned], the yogin then undertakes the repeated practice which aims at yoga. (1) Having

paid homage to [his] chosen deity and to [his] preceptor carefully, facing East, the yogin, after he has become pure, should assume [the following postures] in particular: (2) the lotus, the svastika, the throne, the mound, the joined-hands-posture, and the half-moon, the staff and the all-auspicious. (3) Thus, the subject relating to the postures is taught through [these] eight names; I will explain their different forms, in due succession. (4)

Notes

- The "eight means" (*aṣṭau sādhanāni*) refer to the eight auxiliary practices described in the preceding chapter of the Dharmaputrikā; they are the preliminary purification required before postural practice.
- Facing east (*prāṅmukha*) and ritual purity (*śuci*) are standard preliminary conditions for yogic and ritual practice.
- In verse 3 the first three postures are grouped in a neuter plural compound (*padma-svastika-pīṭhāni*), after which the remaining five are named individually.
- In verse 4 the edition reads *saṃsthānabhedan tu* (with a final *-n*); this is an editorial realization of the anusvāra before *t-*, for *saṃsthānabhedaṃ tu* ("the different forms").

1. Padmāsana — The Lotus Posture (verses 5–9)

Devanagari

आस्थित्योत्तानपादाग्रौ ग्रन्थिवच्चेतरेतरौ ।
ऊर्वोरुपरि विन्यस्य श्लिष्टपार्ष्णी सुसंस्थितौ ॥५॥
उत्तानं वामहस्ताग्रं पार्ष्ण्योरुपरि विन्यसेत्।
तस्योपरि पुनस्तद्वत्स्थाप्य दक्षिणपल्लवं॥६॥
अवक्रस्तब्धनिस्यन्दं गात्रशैलावलम्बितं।
बाहुयुग्मं तथा कार्यं यथा मृदुलताद्वयं॥७॥
समुद्भवदथोष्ठाभ्यामगाढपिहितं मुखं।
दन्ताग्रे न्यस्य जिह्वाग्रं स्थिरं ग्रीवा च मस्तकं॥८॥
नासाग्रमात्रदृष्ट्यर्धनिमीलल्लोचनद्वयं।
पद्मासनमिति ज्ञेयं प्रशस्तं सर्वयोगिभिः ॥९॥

IAST

āsthityottānapādāgrau granthivac cetaretarau |
ūrvor upari vinyasya śliṣṭapārṣṇī susaṃsthitau ||5||
uttānaṃ vāmahastāgraṃ pārṣṇyor upari vinyaset |
tasyopari punas tadvat sthāpya dakṣiṇapallavam ||6||
avakrastabdhanisyandaṃ gātraśailāvalambitam |
bāhuyugmaṃ tathā kāryaṃ yathā mṛdulatādvayam ||7||
samudbhavad athoṣṭhābhyām agāḍhapihitaṃ mukham |
dantāgre nyasya jihvāgraṃ sthiraṃ grīvā ca mastakam ||8||

nāsāgramātradṛṣṭyardhanimīlallocanadvayam |
padmāsanam iti jñeyaṃ praśastaṃ sarvayogibhiḥ ||9||

Word-for-word Analysis

Verse 5

- āsthitya — having placed / maintained (an irregular absolutive, probably for āsthāpya); uttāna-pādāgrau — the two tips of the upturned feet (dual); granthi-vat — like a knot; ca — and; itaretarau — one over the other, mutually (dual); ūrvoḥ — of the two thighs; upari — above, upon; vinyasya — having placed; śliṣṭa-pārṣṇī — with the heels joined together (dual); susaṃsthitau — well placed / firmly fixed (dual).

Verse 6

- uttānam — upturned; vāma-hastāgram — the tip / fingers of the left hand; pārṣṇyoḥ — on the two heels; upari — above; vinyaset — should place; tasya — of that; upari — above; punaḥ — again; tadvat — in the same way; sthāpya — having placed; dakṣiṇa-pallavam — the right 'sprout' (i.e. the fingers of the right hand).

Verse 7

- avakra — not crooked, straight; stabdha — fixed, immovable; niṣyandam — flowing / hanging down; gātra-śaila — the mountain of the body; avalambitam — hanging from; bāhu-yugmam — the pair of arms; tathā — thus; kāryam — should be made; yathā — like, as; mṛdu-latā-dvayam — two delicate creepers.

Verse 8

- samudbhavat — standing out, protruding; atha — then; oṣṭhābhyām — by the two lips; agāḍha-pihitam — not tightly closed; mukham — the mouth; danta-agre — on the tip / front of the teeth; nyasya — having placed; jihvā-agram — the tip of the tongue; sthiram — firm; grīvā — the neck; ca — and; mastakam — the head.

Verse 9

- nāsā-agra — the tip of the nose; mātra — only; dṛṣṭi — the gaze; ardha-nimīla — half-closed; locana-dvayam — the two eyes; padma-āsanam — the lotus posture; iti — thus; jñeyam — is to be known; praśastam — praised, commended; sarva-yogibhiḥ — by all yogins.

Literal Translation

Having placed the two tips of the upturned feet one over the other like a knot, having placed [them] upon the two thighs with the heels joined and firmly fixed, (5) one should place the upturned fingers of the left hand upon the two heels, and having again placed the right "sprout" [the fingers of the right hand] on top of them in the same way, (6) the pair of arms should be

made like two delicate creepers hanging from the mountain of the body, flowing straight and immovable; (7) then, the mouth standing out by reason of the two lips and not tightly closed, having placed the tip of the tongue on the tip of the teeth, the neck and head being firm, (8) with the gaze only on the tip of the nose and the two eyes half-closed — this is to be known as the lotus posture, praised by all yogins. (9)

Literary Translation

Having maintained the two points of the upturned feet one over the other like a knot, having placed both heels tightly joined together on the two thighs, (5) [the yogin] must place the upturned fingers of the left hand on the two heels, [and] having placed again the fingers of the right [hand] on the [fingers of the left hand] in the same way, (6) the two arms should be shaped like two delicate creepers hanging from the stone-like body, flowing straight and immovable, (7) then, the mouth slightly closed, standing out due to the two lips, having placed the tip of the tongue on the tip of the teeth, neck and head being firm, (8) with the two eyes half-closed, the gaze [fixed] only on the tip of the nose, [this is] known as the posture [named] padma, praised by all yogins. (9)

Notes

- This is an early description of the classic lotus posture with a full superstructure of hand, arm, mouth, tongue, and gaze instructions. The hands rest palm-up on the heels, right upon left; the arms hang relaxed "like two delicate creepers."
- The tongue-tip placed at the front teeth and the half-closed gaze fixed on the nose-tip are standard early yogic techniques for fixing the mind (*dhāraṇā*).
- Philological: the absolutive *āsthitya* (v. 5) is non-standard, most likely for *āsthāpya* ("having placed"); the translator renders it "having maintained." In v. 9 the compound *ardha-nimīla-locana* means "having the eyes half-closed."

2. Svastikāsana — The Svastika Posture (verses 10–11)

Devanagari

स्थातव्यौ भूतले पादावासनस्थेन योगिना ।
दक्षिणं वामभागे तु वामपादन्तु दक्षिणे ॥१०॥
अन्योन्याभिमुखं कृत्वा मृगशीर्षकरद्वयं।
पूर्वोक्तेनैव गात्रेण स्वस्तिकासनसंज्ञितं॥११॥

IAST

sthātavyau bhūtale pādāv āsanasthena yoginā |
dakṣiṇaṃ vāmabhāge tu vāmapādan tu dakṣiṇe ||10||
anyonyābhimukhaṃ kṛtvā mṛgaśīrṣakaradvayam |
pūrvoktenaiva gātreṇa svastikāsanasaṃjñitam ||11||

Word-for-word Analysis

Verse 10

- sthātavyau — should be placed (dual gerundive); bhūtale — on the ground; pādau — the two feet (dual); āsana-sthena — seated in the posture; yoginā — by the yogin; dakṣiṇam — the right [foot]; vāma-bhāge — on the left side; tu — and; vāma-pādam — the left foot; dakṣiṇe — on the right [side].

Verse 11

- anyonya-abhimukham — facing one another; kṛtvā — having made; mṛga-śīrṣa — the 'deer's head' (a hand gesture / mudrā); kara-dvayam — the two hands; pūrva-uktena — as said before; eva — just; gātreṇa — with the [upper] body; svastikā-āsana-saṃjñitam — called the svastika posture.

Literal Translation

By the yogin seated in the posture, the two feet should be placed on the ground, the right [foot] on the left side and the left foot on the right [side]; (10) having made the two hands face one another in the deer's-head gesture, with the [upper] body positioned just as said before, [this is] called the svastika posture. (11)

Literary Translation

The yogin being seated, both feet should be placed on the ground, the right foot being on the left side, the left foot on the right [side], (10) having put both hands, one facing the other, in the *mṛgaśīrṣa* position, the [upper] body [positioned] as has been mentioned before, [this is] the posture called svastika. (11)

Notes

- The legs are crossed so that each foot lies on the opposite side — the familiar cross-legged "svastika" seat.
- The *mṛgaśīrṣa* ("deer's head") is a named hand gesture; here the two hands are held facing one another. The upper body, tongue, and gaze follow the instructions already given for Padmāsana ("as said before").
- Philological: the edition reads *vāmapādan tu* (v. 10), an editorial *-n* for *vāmapādaṃ tu* ("and the left foot").

3. Pīṭhāsana — The Throne Posture (verse 12)

Devanagari

आसनस्थेन पादौ द्वौ न्यस्येतां भूतले समं।
जानुद्वये हस्ततलं स्थाप्य पीठासनं भवेत्॥१२॥

IAST

āsanasthena pādau dvau nyasyetāṃ bhūtale samam |
jānudvaye hastatalaṃ sthāpya pīṭhāsanaṃ bhavet ||12||

Word-for-word Analysis

Verse 12

- āsana-sthena — by [the yogin] seated in the posture; pādau dvau — the two feet; nyasyetām — should be placed (dual optative); bhūtale — on the ground; samam — evenly, parallel; jānu-dvaye — on the two knees; hasta-talam — the palm of the hands; sthāpya — having placed; pīṭha-āsanam — the throne posture; bhavet — is / becomes.

Literal Translation

By [the yogin] seated in the posture, the two feet should be placed evenly on the ground; having placed the palms of the hands on the two knees, [this] becomes the throne posture.

Literary Translation

[The yogin] being seated, both feet should be placed parallel on the ground; after he has placed the palm of the hands on both knees, [this is] the posture [named] pīṭha. (12)

Notes

- A simple upright seat: feet flat and parallel on the floor, palms resting on the knees — the posture of sitting on a "throne" (*pīṭha*).

4. Sthalāsana — The Mound Posture (verse 13)

Devanagari

एवमेवासनाभावे भुवि स्थित्वा प्रयत्नतः ।
बाहूरुजङ्घासुश्लिष्टं स्थलासनमुदीरितं॥१३॥

IAST

evam evāsanābhāve bhuvi sthitvā prayatnataḥ |
bāhūrujaṅghāsuśliṣṭaṃ sthalāsanam udīritam ||13||

Word-for-word Analysis

Verse 13

- evam eva — just so, similarly; āsana-abhāve — in the absence of a seat / without being seated; bhuvi — on the ground; sthitvā — having stood; prayatnataḥ — with effort, carefully; bāhu-ūru-jaṅghāsu — in the arms, thighs, and shanks; su-śliṣṭam — well joined, firmly tightened; sthala-āsanam — the mound posture; udīritam — is declared / called.

Literal Translation

Just so, without being seated, having stood on the ground with effort, with the arms, thighs, and shanks firmly tightened, [this] is declared the mound posture.

Literary Translation

Without being seated, standing similarly on the ground with special effort, arms, thighs, [and] shanks firmly tightened, [this is] the posture called sthala. (13)

Notes

- This is a **standing** posture (*āsana* here used in the sense of "standing"), the body held rigid and compact like a "mound" (*sthala*). The phrase *āsanābhāve* ("in the absence of sitting") makes explicit that the practitioner is upright rather than seated.

5. Añjalikāsana — The Joined-Hands Posture (verse 14)

Devanagari

भुवि स्थित्वा तु जानुभ्यां स्तब्धगात्रेण योगिना ।
हृदि हस्तपुटं कार्यं ज्ञेयमञ्जलिकासनं॥१४॥

IAST

bhuvi sthitvā tu jānubhyāṃ stabdhagātreṇa yoginā |
hṛdi hastapuṭaṃ kāryaṃ jñeyam añjalikāsanam ||14||

Word-for-word Analysis

Verse 14

- bhuvi — on the ground; sthitvā — having stood / rested; tu — and; jānubhyām — on the two knees; stabdha-gātreṇa — with the body immovable; yoginā — by the yogin; hṛdi — at the heart; hasta-puṭam — the hollow of the hands (the añjali, cupped / joined hands); kāryam — should be made; jñeyam — is to be known; añjalikā-āsanam — the joined-hands posture.

Literal Translation

Having rested on the ground on the two knees, by the yogin whose body is immovable a hollow of the hands should be made at the heart; [this] is to be known as the joined-hands posture.

Literary Translation

Standing on the knees resting on the ground, the yogin whose body is immovable must form on the heart a hollow with the hands; [this] posture is known as añjalika. (14)

Notes

- A kneeling posture: the practitioner kneels with the body still and forms the *añjali* (cupped, joined hands) at the heart — a gesture of reverence. *hasta-puṭa* literally means the "hollow / cup of the hands."

6. Ardhacandrāsana — The Half-Moon Posture (verse 15)

Devanagari

तलपादेन वामेन जानुना दक्षिणेन च ।
स्थित्वा हस्तपुटं कार्यमर्धचन्द्रासनं विदुः ॥१५॥

IAST

talapādena vāmena jānunā dakṣiṇena ca |
sthitvā hastapuṭaṃ kāryam ardhacandrāsanaṃ viduḥ ||15||

Word-for-word Analysis

Verse 15

- tala-pādena — with the sole of the foot; vāmena — the left; jānunā — with the knee; dakṣiṇena — the right; ca — and; sthitvā — having stood; hasta-puṭam — the hollow of the hands; kāryam — should be made; ardha-candra-āsanam — the half-moon posture; viduḥ — they [the wise] know.

Literal Translation

Having stood with the sole of the left foot and with the right knee, [the yogin] should make the hollow of the hands [at the heart]; they know [this] as the half-moon posture.

Literary Translation

Standing on the left foot and on the right knee, [the yogin] must form [on the heart] a hollow with the hands; they know [this] posture as ardhacandra. (15)

Notes

- An asymmetrical kneeling posture: the left foot is planted on its sole while the right knee rests on the ground, the hands again forming the *añjali* at the heart (supplied from the previous verse). The bent, offset shape of the body gives the "half-moon" (*ardhacandra*) its name.

7. Daṇḍāsana — The Staff Posture (verse 16)

Devanagari

अग्रे प्रसारितौ पादौ सुश्लिष्टौ भूमिसंस्थितौ ।
उपवेश्यार्धकायं तु दण्डासनमिति स्मृतं॥१६॥

IAST

agre prasāritau pādau suśliṣṭau bhūmisaṃsthitau |
upaveśyārdhakāyaṃ tu daṇḍāsanam iti smṛtam ||16||

Word-for-word Analysis

Verse 16

- agre — in front, ahead; prasāritau — stretched out (dual); pādau — the two feet / legs; su-sliṣṭau — firmly joined (dual); bhūmi-saṃsthitau — resting on the ground (dual); upaveśya — having seated; ardha-kāyam — half of the body (the lower half); tu — and; daṇḍa-āsanam — the staff posture; iti — thus; smṛtam — is called / remembered.

Literal Translation

The two feet stretched out ahead, firmly joined, resting on the ground, having seated the [lower] half of the body — this is called the staff posture.

Literary Translation

Both feet stretched ahead, firmly joined, placed on the ground, after having sat the [lower] half of the body, this is the posture called daṇḍa. (16)

Notes

- The seated "staff" posture: legs extended straight forward and pressed together, the body upright like a staff (*daṇḍa*). This corresponds to the modern daṇḍāsana.

8. Sarvatobhadrāsana — The All-Auspicious Posture (verse 17)

Devanagari

समपादलब्धभूमिरधिजानुकरान्वितं।
सम्बद्धमसम्बद्धं वा सर्वतोभद्रमासनं ॥१७॥

IAST

samapādalabdhabhūmir adhijānukarānvitam |
sambaddham asambaddhaṃ vā sarvatobhadram āsanaṃ ||17||

Word-for-word Analysis

Verse 17

- sama-pāda-labdha-bhūmiḥ — [the hands] reaching the ground at the same level as the feet; adhi-jānu — between / over the knees; kara-anvitam — furnished with the hands, i.e. with the hands placed; sambaddham — bound, tied, closed; asambaddham — unbound, untied, open; vā — or; sarvato-bhadram — the all-auspicious; āsanam — posture.

Literal Translation

[The hands] reaching the ground at the same level as the feet, placed between the knees, [the position] being bound or unbound — [this is] the all-auspicious posture.

Literary Translation

The hands [placed] between the knees [in such a way that] they reach the ground at the same level as the feet, [the position] being tied or untied, is the sarvatobhadra posture. (17)

Notes

- The final posture of the series: the hands are placed between the knees so that they touch the ground level with the feet. The alternative "bound or unbound" (*sambaddham asambaddhaṃ vā*) likely refers to whether the limbs are locked / interlocked or left loose. The name *sarvato-bhadra* ("auspicious on every side") marks it as a complete, all-round auspicious seat.

Colophon

Devanagari

इति धर्मपुत्रिकायां संहितायामासनप्रकरणं नाम द्वितीयः पटलः ॥

IAST

iti dharmaputrikāyāṃ saṃhitāyāṃ āsanaprakaraṇaṃ nāma dvitīyaḥ paṭalaḥ ||

Word-for-word Analysis

Colophon

- iti — thus [ends]; dharmaputrikāyām — in the Dharmaputrikā; saṃhitāyām — the collection / compendium; āsana-prakaraṇam nāma — named 'The Section on the Postures'; dvitīyaḥ — the second; paṭalaḥ — chapter.

Translation

Thus [ends] the second chapter, named "The Section on the Postures" (Āsanaprakaraṇam), in the Dharmaputrikā Saṃhitā.

Translator's Note (from the source)

Translation by Christèle Barois. The Sanskrit text given here is based on the Wellcome Library's apograph of a Nepalese manuscript of the 12th century, and on the edition of the text published in Kathmandu in 1998. The draft of the critical edition of the Dharmaputrikā, by Nirajan Kafle and Anil Kumar Acharya, has also been consulted. A collective reading with the Haṭha Yoga Project's researchers Jason Birch, James Mallinson, and Mark Singleton, and with Nirajan Kafle, has greatly contributed to clarifying some passages. This text has benefited from a final reading with T. Ganesan, Director of the Department of Indology at the French Institute of Pondicherry. I also address my heartfelt thanks to Dagmar Wujastyk for her several valuable suggestions. An article that will give the critical apparatus of the Sanskrit text is forthcoming.

> **Note on the collaborators named above.** The names are reproduced exactly as the blog post gives them (2017). Barois's later article names a different collaboration for the same critical edition: "The critical edition of the Dharmaputrikā is currently being carried out in collaboration with Philipp A. Maas and Anil Kumar Acharya (forthcoming 2022)" (Barois 2020, p. 6, n. 5 [S3]). Both statements are quoted as they stand; this document does not adjudicate between them.

General Notes on the Text and Its Terminology

1. **The eight postures in order:** padmāsana (lotus), svastikāsana (svastika), pīṭhāsana (throne), sthalāsana (mound), añjalikāsana (joined hands), ardhacandrāsana (half-moon), daṇḍāsana (staff), sarvatobhadrāsana (all-auspicious).
2. **Historical significance (as stated by the source publication):** the blog describes this chapter as "an ancient and unparalleled testimony of a systematic and detailed description of a closed group of yogic postures, preceding by at least two centuries the description of postures in the *Yogaśāstra* by Hemacandra (12th century)" [S1]. That comparative claim is

the source's, and is reproduced here without independent verification. What the verses themselves show is that not all eight postures are seated: sthalāsana is performed standing (v. 13, *āsanābhāve*), and añjalikāsana involves kneeling (v. 14) — see the notes to those verses.

3. **Non-standard Sanskrit:** The text preserves several irregular or epic-style forms (e.g. the absolutive āsthitya in v. 5, and editorial nasal spellings such as *bhedan tu* and *vāmapādan tu*). These are noted in the relevant sections and normalized in the word-for-word analysis.
4. **Reconstructed Devanagari:** The source gives the Sanskrit only in roman transliteration; the Devanagari above has been generated from that transliteration and preserves the edition's readings.

References (Sources for the Dating)

[S1] Barois, Christèle. 2017. "Eight Yoga Postures in the Dharmaputrikā." *AyurYog* (project blog, University of Vienna), 19 January 2017. Original URL (as printed in the uploaded PDF): `https://ayuryog.org/blog/eight-yoga-postures-dharmaputrikā` — currently returns a 404 error. Archived version (verified, matches the uploaded PDF): <https://web.archive.org/web/20221207075113/http://ayuryog.org/blog/eight-yoga-postures-dharmaputrik%C4%81> (Internet Archive capture, 7 December 2022).

[S2] De Simini, Florinda. 2016. "Śivadharma Manuscripts from Nepal and the Making of a Śaiva Corpus." In *One-Volume Libraries: Composite and Multiple-Text Manuscripts*, edited by Michael Friedrich and Cosima Schwarke, 233–286. Berlin / Boston: De Gruyter. DOI: <https://doi.org/10.1515/9783110496956-009>. Open-access author version: <https://unora.unior.it/retrieve/dfd1bedc-f5d9-d55a-e053-3705fe0af723/De%20Simini%202016a%20S%CC%81ivadharma%20mss%20final.pdf>. Cited passages: p. 243 and n. 28 (ULC Add. 1645, 1139–40 CE; ASC G 4077 named as the earliest dated corpus manuscript identified so far); p. 251 and n. 44, n. 47 (ASC G 4077, 1035–36 CE / 6 July 1036 CE, lacks the Dharmaputrikā); p. 252 and n. 49 (NAK 3–393, 24 May 1069 CE, contains the Dharmaputrikā); p. 270 (summary of the dated manuscripts, where Add. 1645 is given as 1138–39 CE); p. 273 (Appendix I: the Asiatic Society of Calcutta manuscripts are not described there, and the reader is referred to the catalogues).

[S3] Barois, Christèle. 2020. "The Dharmaputrikā Saṃhitā: Preliminary Notes on an Early Text on Yoga." *Journal of Yoga Studies* 3: 5–76. DOI: <https://doi.org/10.34000/JoYS.2020.V3.002>. Open access: <https://journalofyogastudies.org/index.php/JoYS/article/download/2020.V3.BAROIS.DhPS/2020.V3.BAROIS.DhPS/117>. Cited passages: p. 6 (11th–12th-century manuscripts; about 350 ślokas in sixteen chapters); p. 6 n. 4 (the single eleventh-century manuscript in which the Lalitavistara replaces the Dharmaputrikā); p. 6 n. 5 (collaborators on the critical edition); p. 16 n. 28 (the "1069 A.D." date identified as the date of the copy of the manuscript); pp. 20–21 (hypothesis of a 7th-century terminus ad quem).

[S4] Powell, Seth. 2018. "Etched in Stone: Sixteenth-century Visual and Material Evidence of Śaiva Ascetics and Yogis in Complex Non-seated Āsanas at Vijayanagara." *Journal of Yoga Studies* 1: 45–106. DOI: <https://doi.org/10.34000/JoYS.2018.V1.003>. Open access: <https://journalofyogastudies.org/index.php/JoYS/article/download/2018.v1.Powell.EtchedinStone/3/>. Cited passage: p. 60 (repeats the "c. 10th century" dating, citing Barois).

End of Chapter 2 of the Dharmaputrikā.